

Skava is Looking to Hire Smart Programmers

It's not just about knowing how to code. These days, it's also about smart programming. Young companies like Skava Inc are looking to hire smart engineers, who can write good code, despite the current turbulence in the global economic situation. **Diksha P Gupta** from **Open Source For You** spoke to **Arish Ali, CEO and co-founder, Skava Inc**, about the firm's hiring plans in India. Read on...



Arish Ali, CEO and co-founder, Skava Inc

It was in 2003 that a firm called Skava Inc came into being. Two enterprising brains came together to build something that was not only futuristic but also very business-oriented. They started developing mobile applications that year. Skava built the first retail site that was fully optimised for tablets, for Staples, the second largest online retailer in America. Currently, the company is working with multiple retailers, developing their in-store technology solutions.

Skava has recently announced the opening of its new development centre in Coimbatore. Located in the Tidel Park, the 2787 sq m (30,000 square foot) facility can house up to 400 employees. The centre will serve as a hub for Skava's product development, services and customer support. Skava works to provide mobile and omni-commerce solutions to many of the top tier retailers in the US, and is a known name in this space.

Speaking about the facility, Arish Ali, chief executive officer and co-founder, Skava Inc, said, "We have launched this new state-of-the-art development centre at the Tidel Park, Coimbatore. We have been in this city right from when we started out. This new facility allows us to build our

centre of excellence here, which can house up to 400 people. We are a development company and we develop mobile commerce software. To be precise, we develop platforms for mobile commerce, shopping on mobile devices, etc. The centre will serve as a hub for Skava's product development, services and customer support. We already have about 180 people working on developing our software. We have a couple of sales offices outside India as well. The new Coimbatore facility has the capacity for 400 people. So we will be hiring additional talent in the next two years."

Jobs for smart engineers!

Though Skava's new facility is looking to hire engineers, not all engineers will fit the bill. Ali explains, "Our target is to hire smart engineers. By smart engineers, I mean people who can write good code, people who have a problem solving attitude and can be instrumental in bringing out great products. The technologies that we use are some of the most current and cutting edge. We develop technologies for all mobile operating systems. Smartphones and tablet devices are the target devices our software runs on. We provide really scalable technology at the back-end. Our customers are among the biggest retailers in the US, who use our mobile commerce solutions. They are happy with our solutions because they are able to handle the volume of users through our technology, on a day to day basis. So, that's where the quality of the product that we build is important and, hence, the workforce we hire plays a role."

Choosing Coimbatore as the place to develop this facility was a conscious and meticulous decision. He shares the importance of the city saying, "Coimbatore has tremendous talent and infrastructure to offer. The educational institutions at Coimbatore have been a fertile pool of outstanding engineers for us. That is why Coimbatore has always been at the heart of our growth strategy and the opening of this state-of-the-art new centre shows our commitment to the city and its people."

Open source technology plays a major role

The company uses a lot of open source technology, but chooses it with a lot of care. Ali asserts, "We do use open source technology, but we exercise enough caution and choose it very meticulously for our products. Some of the